QP **25900379**

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

Value Addition Course (VAC) - MG3VACENGA00 - **KALPAVRIKSHA: EXPLORING INDIA THROUGH STORIES, SONGS, SCIENCE & SOUL**

Duration: 1 Hours Maximum Marks: 50

Scheme of Valuation

Part A

Fill in the Blanks

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. Shakuni [CO1]
2. Dumka [CO2]
3. Whale [CO3]
4. Mantra of Brahmastra [CO1]
5. Red saree [CO2]
6. Ghost [CO3]
7. Drupada's [CO1]
8. Bitter gourd creeper [CO3]
9. Monkey [CO1]
10. Weaknesses (related terms can be granted marks) [CO2]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Paragraph Questions

Answer any 5 questions. Each question carries 8 marks

11. Seeta gave Hanuman her jewel (choodamani) and narrated incidents known only to Rama and herself, such as how he broke the bow at her swayamvara. These personal tokens and recollections served as proof of their meeting. [CO1]
12. The headmaster's shame is internal and moral—stemming from his awareness of personal inadequacy and societal judgment. Vellayi-appan's shame is existential—rooted in helplessness before fate and injustice. Both reflect how shame functions as an inner mirror of conscience shaped by social and emotional codes. [CO2]
13. Tinai (landscape ecology in Sangam literature) represents the deep interconnection between land, mood, and life. Each tinai corresponds to specific emotions and human activities (love, valour, grief), showing how environment and humanity co-exist harmoniously. [CO3]
14. Kripacharya symbolises the voice of dharma and restraint amidst chaos. His counsel to Aswatthama before the night slaughter illustrates the enduring struggle between

righteousness and vengeance in the Mahabharata. He upholds the moral law even when others abandon it. [CO1]

15. In Sweet Pudding, food signifies domestic bonding and care amid poverty and emotional distance. In Biriyani, it becomes a marker of identity, culture, and communal sharing, symbolising social belonging. Both use food as emotional and cultural language connecting personal and social spaces. [CO2]
16. Sounds include the buzz of bees, chirping of crickets, rustling leaves, calling of birds, and the whisper of the wind—all merging human emotion with the rhythms of nature. [CO3]
17. Children's innocence provides hope and purity against the backdrop of despair and injustice. In both stories, their naive actions mirror the world's lost morality, offering a spiritual redemption to adult suffering. [CO2]
18. The dominant tone is ironic compassion. Through the servants' simple speech, the poem reflects empathy, satire, and the subtle dignity of the marginalised. [CO3]

[8x5 = 40]